

Visual Production System

The approved foundations — visual direction, colour system, Element Compass, form language, outline, rendering, materials, shop atmosphere, UI, product, customer, region, VFX and motion direction, Golden Sample strategy and generation contract — are locked and not restated for revision here. This document turns them into the operational layer: the rules an asset must obey, the per-category specification it is built against, the prompt scaffolding it is generated from, and the gates it must pass to be accepted.

Scope note: no product catalogue, customer roster, route list, state machine, asset count or production manifest is defined or implied anywhere in this document. Those arrive later from the game implementation. Everything below is category-level and content-agnostic, using placeholders in their place.

1 • Style Lock

Twelve mandatory rules. They are not preferences and not per-category — every future asset, in every category, obeys all twelve. A violation is a rework, not a discussion.

SL-01 Silhouette first. 1–3 dominant silhouette features, separated volumes, still recognisable as a flat black shape with all interior detail deleted.

SL-03 One key light. Soft, clearly directed, slightly warm. Shadows are large connected shapes. No second competing light, no ambient-occlusion grime, no studio setup.

SL-05 Highlight budget: 1–2. Material-dependent – diffuse on fur and cloth, tight on metal and glass, strongest on magic. Never a realistic specular.

SL-07 Form ratio 60–70 / 20–30 / 10. Soft-round base, clean-angular accents, sharp-magical spice. Category may shift the mix; nothing may abandon the round majority except sharp magical objects.

SL-09 Glow is earned. Elemental energy, active selection, masterwork, discovery, capture, special creature reaction. Nowhere else. The core glows; the surrounding form stays legible.

SL-11 Detail ceiling. Micro-detail is spent on the main form, not scattered. Any detail invisible at the asset's smallest in-game size is deleted rather than kept.

SL-02 Outline is always present. Visible, deliberate, medium weight; heavier on the exterior than interior; dark but warm-tinted toward the material, never pure black. No hairline lineart, no hard comic ink, no outline-free rendering.

SL-04 Cel-painterly shading only. Between clean cel bands and soft digital painting. No photoreal texture, no PBR, no micro-noise, no visible brush chaos.

SL-06 Material through shape. Stone reads as faceted planes, fur as soft volume transitions, wood as thick simplified planks, energy as glow plus colour contrast. Never through texture fidelity.

SL-08 Warm base, element as accent. The approved base palette carries the object; Element Compass colour enters as accent, symbol, glow or silhouette change and never repaints the asset.

SL-10 Contrast hierarchy is absolute. UI > interactive object > props > environment > far background, in saturation, contrast and detail density. Never inverted for a nice picture.

SL-12 Catchmons stay the stars. Nothing may out-silhouette, out-saturate, out-glow or out-detail a Catchmon: not a prop, not a customer, not a background, not a UI frame.

Tone guardrails. Warm, magical, charming, collectible, high-quality. Not realistic. Not grimdark. Not childish. Not generic mobile-game UI. Premium is produced by light, restraint, clean edges and spacing – never by more gold, more glow, more particles or more detail.

2 • Category Rules

Each category inherits all twelve Style Lock rules and then adds only what is specific to it. Canvas sizes below are production defaults for authoring masters, not claims about what the game will request.

Shop Environments

Camera soft elevated 3/4 diorama — high enough for spatial depth, low enough that figures stay large. · **Master** wide opaque canvas, 4:3 or wider, layered base / shadow / glow. · **Form** round-warm majority, angular in work areas. · **Palette** warm wood, sandstone, ceramic, cloth, metal fittings, glass, paper, leather accents. · **Light** warm ambient plus local sources, soft shadows, subtle rimlight — neither dark tavern nor sterile studio. · **Density** mid-low; walls and far background desaturated and softened below the interactive layer. · **Zoning** distinguished by material, props, lighting, colour temperature, floor pattern and station silhouette — never by hard architectural walls. · **Must** clear walking paths, deliberate empty floor for UI, visible craft life, room for a Catchmon at true scale. · **Never** clutter as a substitute for growth, gold everywhere, glowing every surface, background out-contrasting the foreground.

Stations

Camera the same elevated 3/4 as the environment it sits in. · **Master** square, transparent, one state per file, shared origin and footprint across states. · **Form** archetype-driven: warm and round for care and provisioning; robust and angular for fieldwork; symmetrical and glass-cored for resonance; modular and organic for habitat work. · **Palette** shop base materials, element accent only where the station's purpose is elemental. · **States** a state is communicated by a working component, small motion, light or particles — never by recolouring the whole station. Completion is one clear pulse, not a sustained display. · **Must** read as a workplace with a purpose visible without text; upgrades show as better materials and structure, not new architecture. · **Never** a station louder than the product it makes, or an active state that changes the silhouette so much it looks like a different object.

Displays

Camera shared 3/4, matched horizon with the products it carries. · **Master** transparent, with a defined presentation surface and a consistent product footprint. · **Form** clean, calm, quietly crafted. · **Palette** lower saturation and lower detail than any product placed on it. · **Must** frame the product and lead the eye to it; premium tiers gain material quality, light and structure. · **Never** ornament that competes with the product, gold frames as a quality signal, or a display that reads as the hero of the shot.

Products

Camera one single shared 3/4 product angle across the entire catalogue, no exceptions. · **Master** 1024×1024, transparent, generous safe margin, object centred, consistent optical size within a family, soft ground shadow authored on its own layer. · **Form** family-driven: warm and round for consumables; soft and textile for care; clear-cut with visible fastenings for wearables; robust and angular for field gear; functional with a small magical or technical accent for capture and discovery gear; stronger element colour with controlled glow for elemental craft; organic and friendly for habitat and enrichment. · **Detail** large material areas, 1–2 highlights, minimal micro-detail. · **Quality tiers** the base artwork never changes – refinement is expressed by material finish, light edge, frame and controlled glow in the overlay layers. · **Must** read at 64–96 px; suggest the same light source and shadow convention as every sibling product. · **Never** a baked background, an off-angle hero shot, a product rendered more realistically than a Catchmon.

Routine Materials

Camera shared 3/4 product angle. · **Master** 1024×1024 transparent, centred, single object or one small deliberate cluster. · **Form** the simplest honest shape the material can have. · **Palette** natural colour coding so the material is identified by hue and shape alone. · **Detail** the lowest in the system – recognition speed beats charm here. · **Must** be instantly distinguishable from its neighbours in a dense grid. · **Never** decorative flourishes, magical glow, rarity framing or storytelling props.

Special Components

Camera shared 3/4 product angle. · **Master** 1024×1024 transparent, base and glow layers separated. · **Form** stronger and more sculptural than a routine material; a sharp or crystalline accent is allowed. · **Palette** Element Compass primary plus secondary, glow hue reserved for the core. · **Must** carry a legible element or region identity through form as well as colour, and stay clearly below legendary intensity. · **Never** full-body glow, particle storms, or so much rarity treatment that it competes with a Catchmon.

Customers

Camera one shared character angle and one shared eye-line logic across all figures. · **Master** transparent, full figure, consistent height reference and ground contact. · **Form** stylised humanoid, slightly enlarged head and hands, clear silhouette, reduced facial detail, friendly shapes. · **Palette** lower saturation than the Catchmons and the products they are looking at. · **Clothing** modern-fantasy, crafted, cozy-adventure, optional light regional influence – no historical costume, no literal streetwear, no fashion realism. · **Expression** prefer a small set of base poses plus swappable expressions and transform motion over many fully rendered variants. · **Must** stay visually subordinate: quieter silhouette, less glow, lower saturation, simpler outfit than a central Catchmon. · **Never** glossy anime eyes as a default, hero-character treatment, or detail density above the creature layer.

Regions

Camera illustrative diorama view with clear depth. · **Master** wide opaque canvas, foreground / midground / background authored as separate layers. · **Composition** one dominant landform motif, 1-2 element cues, deliberate quiet zones reserved for UI. · **Element** expressed through geology, flora, atmosphere and light behaviour, not a colour wash. · **Palette** more atmospheric than the shop but the same rendering language, saturation and contrast held below the interactive layer. · **Must** stay organised, playful and illustrative, with shapes a Catchmon can plausibly stand in. · **Never** dense concept art, competing focal points, or atmosphere so strong it swallows UI.

Route Art

Camera a cropped landscape excerpt derived from the region language. · **Master** card-ratio, opaque, safe area for labels. · **Composition** strong horizontal or diagonal read with one visual destination. · **Detail** clearly below region key art — this is a legible card, not a poster. · **Must** remain readable behind UI at card size and inherit the parent region's element cues. · **Never** full region complexity shrunk down, or text-hostile busy centres.

UI Components

Foundations approved radius family XS 6 / S 10 / M 14 / L 18 / XL 24, pill reserved for short status markers; shadow family small / card / modal / world, never pure black; approved base and semantic colours only. · **Panels** warm ground, slight inner depth, one controlled border, soft shadow — no glass morphism, no stacked border layers. · **Buttons** primary filled with visible depth and a firm pressed state; secondary softer fill with a thin border; destructive red-brown, never neon. · **Cards** asset prominent, status secondary, generous padding, at most 2-3 accent layers. · **Tabs** selected by fill plus weight, not colour alone. · **Slots** slightly recessed, asset-focused, quality shown by overlay rather than new artwork. · **Mobile** ≥44 px targets, hover never required, status never colour-only, contrast that survives daylight. · **Must** feel derived from the world through warmth, material and small world accents. · **Never** skeuomorphic wood frames, parchment, sci-fi HUD, permanent glow, ambient decorative ornament.

Icons

Master square, transparent, drawn on a shared grid with a shared stroke weight and matched optical mass across the set. · **Form** one clear silhouette, medium outline, minimal interior lines, a light asymmetric fantasy character. · **Test** must be understood without text at 20-24 px. · **Must** keep one visual metaphor per icon and one stroke logic per family. · **Never** fine interior detail, reused metaphors across different meanings, or two icons in the same set with different weights.

VFX

Character short, clear, soft, directed, colour-matched to its element or system. · **Timing** resolved within roughly 1-2 seconds; motion is soft spring, quick ease-out, slight overshoot, brief anticipation – no linear tweens, no shakes, no permanent bounce. · **Master** authored as its own layer over an untouched base asset, reducible for low-end devices. · **Must** stay clear of UI, never obscure the current decision, and read as the same family as its trigger. · **Never** continuous particles, screen-filling bursts, explosions on ordinary interactions, or effects that survive longer than the moment they describe.